

IT'S **NOT** YOUR FAULT

The Workbook — every worksheet from the guide, ready to print

R L B

Companion to the book · thecardinalspromise.com

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GETTING STARTED

■ WORKSHEET — FUTURE PLANNER SNAPSHOT

Who can speak for my parent if they cannot speak for themselves?

Where are the documents, insurance cards, passwords, and medication lists?

What would my parent want if life changed quickly?

What are the three calls we should make before a crisis?

Worksheet 1 of 25 · goes with *Getting Started* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 5 · THE FAMILY MEETING

■ **WORKSHEET — THE FAMILY MEETING**

Bring this to the meeting and fill it out as you talk.

Date of meeting _____

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver _____

Family point person _____

Backup point person _____

Next meeting date _____

Why are we meeting?

What changed? What is unsafe? What decision cannot wait? _____

What matters most to the person receiving care? _____

People in the meeting

NAME	RELATIONSHIP	ROLE IN CARE

Decisions & task assignments

DECISION / TASK	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	DUE DATE
Call doctor / provider		
Update medication list		
Locate / update documents		
Research care options		
Give caregiver a break		

Documents to find or update

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Healthcare Power of Attorney | ☐ DNR / MOST / POLST (if applicable) |
| ☐ Financial Power of Attorney | ☐ Medication List & Doctor List |
| ☐ Living Will / Advance Directive | ☐ Insurance / Medicare / Medicaid / VA information |

☐ Funeral home information

☐ Emergency contacts

This week's three actions

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Family agreement

We are writing this down so one person does not have to carry everything alone. The goal is not a perfect plan. It is to make the next week safer and clearer.

Main caregiver _____

Family point person _____

Family member / helper _____

Date _____

Worksheet 2 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 5 · The Family Meeting* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 6 · HOME HEALTH

■ **WORKSHEET — HOME HEALTH EVALUATION**

Use this before a provider visit or home health evaluation.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Primary doctor / provider / phone _____

Preferred home health agency (if any) _____

Insurance _____

What changed? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Fall or near fall | ☐ Medication concern |
| ☐ New weakness or trouble walking | ☐ Increased confusion |
| ☐ Trouble transferring | ☐ Shortness of breath or pain |
| ☐ Recent hospitalization or rehab stay | ☐ Difficulty bathing, dressing, or toileting |
| ☐ Recent surgery | ☐ Caregiver unable to manage safely |
| ☐ New wound | |

Current safety concerns

CONCERN	YES / NO / UNSURE	NOTES
Safe walking		
Safe transfers		
Safe bathing & toileting		
Medication safety		
Wound or skin concern		
Breathing / swallowing concern		
Confusion or memory concern		
Safe to be alone		

Current equipment in the home (check what applies)

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Cane | ☐ Grab bars |
| ☐ Walker | ☐ Raised toilet seat |
| ☐ Wheelchair | ☐ Bedside commode |
| ☐ Shower chair | ☐ Hospital bed |

☐ Oxygen

☐ Medication organizer

☐ Medical alert device

If home health starts

Agency name & phone _____

Start of care date _____

Primary nurse / therapist _____

Visit schedule _____

DISCIPLINE	NAME	PHONE
Nurse		
Physical therapist		
Occupational therapist		
Speech therapist		
Social worker		
Home health aide		

CHAPTER 7 · PRIVATE DUTY CARE

■ **WORKSHEET — PRIVATE DUTY CARE PLANNING**

Use this before calling agencies or hiring help.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Family point person / phone _____

Care schedule manager / phone _____

Current care needs

NEED	HOW OFTEN?	WHO DOES IT NOW?
Bathing / dressing / toileting		
Meals		
Laundry / cleaning		
Transportation / errands		
Medication reminders		
Companionship / supervision		
Overnight safety		
Dementia support		
Caregiver respite		

Highest-risk times of day (check all that apply)

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Morning | ☐ Weekends |
| ☐ Midday | ☐ Shower days |
| ☐ Afternoon | ☐ Appointment days |
| ☐ Evening | ☐ When caregiver is working |
| ☐ Overnight | ☐ When caregiver needs rest |

Best schedule to try first (check one)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ 2–4 hours, 1–2 days per week | ☐ Overnight care |
| ☐ Morning help several days per week | ☐ Daily care |
| ☐ Evening help several days per week | ☐ 12-hour shifts |
| ☐ Weekend respite | ☐ 24-hour care |

Preferred start date _____

Preferred days & times _____

Minimum hours needed _____

Caregiver preferences

Preferred caregiver gender (if any) / language _____

Dementia experience needed? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Transfer or mobility help needed? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Transportation needed? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Pet & household notes _____

Agency comparison

QUESTION	AGENCY 1	AGENCY 2	AGENCY 3
Agency name & phone			
Hourly rate			
Minimum hours			
Weekend / overnight rate			
Background checks?			
Dementia training?			
Backup coverage?			
Care plan provided?			
Start date available			

CHAPTER 8 · ASSISTED LIVING

■ **WORKSHEET — ASSISTED LIVING TOUR & DECISION**

Use this to compare communities and decide whether the current home plan is still safe. Tour at least three if you can.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Family point person / phone _____

Current living situation _____

Preferred move-in timeframe / budget range _____

Is the current home plan still working? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Living alone no longer feels safe | ☐ The caregiver is exhausted |
| ☐ Falls or near falls are happening | ☐ Private duty care is too expensive or hard to manage |
| ☐ Meals are inconsistent | ☐ The person is isolated or lonely |
| ☐ Medication is being missed or taken incorrectly | ☐ Driving is no longer safe |
| ☐ Bathing or hygiene is not happening regularly | ☐ A spouse caregiver cannot safely continue |

What does the person need help with?

NEED	NO HELP	SOME HELP	A LOT
Bathing / dressing / grooming			
Toileting / incontinence care			
Walking / transfers			
Meals			
Medication			
Housekeeping / laundry			
Transportation			
Nighttime support			
Memory support			

Community comparison

WHAT ACTUALLY DECIDES IT	COMMUNITY 1	COMMUNITY 2	COMMUNITY 3
Name & phone			

Base monthly cost			
Care level cost — and what makes it go up			
What is included, and what is billed on top			
Awake staff overnight? Nurse on site or on call?			
Memory care on site, if it is needed later?			

Five rows, three communities. That is enough to choose. Room type, move-in dates, pets, transportation, and whether hospice can come in all matter — but they rarely decide between two places, so ask them on the tour instead of tracking them here. The care level cost is the row families most often skip and most often regret: ask what it is today, what moves someone to the next level, and what that costs.

CHAPTER 9 · MEMORY CARE

■ **WORKSHEET — MEMORY CARE DECISION**

Use this when dementia is creating safety concerns and the family is deciding whether memory care should be explored.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Family point person / phone _____

Diagnosis (if known) _____

Primary doctor / neurologist / phone _____

Why are we considering memory care? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Wandering or leaving home | ☐ Refusing care |
| ☐ Getting lost | ☐ Unsafe anger or agitation |
| ☐ Unsafe cooking | ☐ Suspicion or paranoia |
| ☐ Medication mistakes | ☐ Cannot call for help reliably |
| ☐ Unsafe driving | ☐ Caregiver exhaustion |
| ☐ Falls or near falls | ☐ Assisted living or home care is not enough |
| ☐ Nighttime confusion | |

Dementia safety snapshot

SAFETY AREA	SAFE	UNSAFE	NOTES
Medication			
Cooking			
Wandering / exits			
Bathing / toileting			
Eating & drinking			
Walking / falls			
Nighttime safety			
Ability to call for help			
Caregiver safety			

Wandering & nighttime notes

Has the person left or tried to leave home? (yes / no / unsure) _____

When does it happen, and where are they trying to go? _____

Is the person confused or unsafe at night? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Is the caregiver sleeping? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Behavior & triggers

Behaviors causing concern _____

Things that calm the person _____

Things that upset the person _____

Best time of day / hardest time of day _____

Memory care community comparison

QUESTION	COMMUNITY 1	COMMUNITY 2	COMMUNITY 3
Community name & phone			
Base monthly / care level cost			
Secure exits & outdoor space?			
Staff dementia training?			
Overnight staffing			
Nurse on site / on call			
Behavior support process			
Fall & medication process			
Family-communication process			
Care needs they cannot manage			

CHAPTER 10 · SKILLED NURSING AND REHAB

■ **WORKSHEET — REHAB & DISCHARGE PLANNING**

Bring this to the care conference and update it as discharge approaches.

Person receiving care _____

Facility & phone _____

Discharge planner / social worker _____

Expected discharge date _____

Recommended level of care after discharge _____

Before vs. now

ABILITY	BEFORE HOSPITAL	NOW
Walking (distance / help needed)		
Transfers (bed, chair, toilet)		
Bathing & dressing		
Toileting / continence		
Stairs		
Memory / confusion		
Eating & drinking		

Care conference questions (check when answered)

- ☐ What has improved, and what has not?
- ☐ What help does the person still need?
- ☐ What is the discharge goal and date?
- ☐ What setting is safest next?
- ☐ What equipment will be needed?
- ☐ Will a home health evaluation be arranged?
- ☐ Is private duty care needed?
- ☐ What training does the family need before discharge?
- ☐ What are the options if home is not safe?

Discharge plan

TASK	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	DUE DATE
------	--------------------	----------

Confirm next care setting		
Arrange equipment		
Set up home health evaluation (if appropriate)		
Arrange private duty care (if needed)		
Gather medication & doctor lists		
Schedule follow-up appointments		

Worksheet 7 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 10 · Skilled Nursing and Rehab* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 11 · PALLIATIVE CARE

■ **WORKSHEET — PALLIATIVE CARE CONVERSATION**

Use this to prepare for a palliative care conversation, ask better questions, and write down what matters most.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Primary doctor / provider / phone _____

Main diagnosis or illness _____

Specialists involved _____

Why are we considering palliative care? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Serious illness is harder to manage | ☐ Family members disagree about the plan |
| ☐ Pain or shortness of breath is difficult to control | ☐ Quality of life is declining |
| ☐ Fatigue or weakness is increasing | ☐ Caregiver stress is increasing |
| ☐ Appetite or weight loss is a concern | ☐ Advance care planning is needed |
| ☐ Repeated hospitalizations or ER visits | ☐ Hospice has been mentioned, but family is unsure |
| ☐ Treatment decisions are becoming confusing | |

Current symptoms (check any present)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Pain | ☐ Anxiety or depression |
| ☐ Shortness of breath | ☐ Confusion |
| ☐ Fatigue / weakness | ☐ Trouble sleeping |
| ☐ Nausea or vomiting | ☐ Difficulty swallowing |
| ☐ Poor appetite / weight loss | ☐ Swelling or wounds |

Daily life snapshot

AREA	BETTER / SAME / WORSE	NOTES
Walking / bathing / dressing		
Eating & sleeping		
Breathing		
Pain control		
Mood & memory		
Caregiver stress		

What matters most? (in the person's own words, if they can answer)

What matters most to you right now? _____

What are you hoping for? _____

What are you most afraid of? _____

What do you want to avoid if possible? _____

Who do you want involved in decisions? _____

Worksheet 8 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 11 · Palliative Care* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 12 · HOSPICE

■ **WORKSHEET — HOSPICE QUESTIONS & DECISION**

Use this when hospice has been mentioned or a serious illness is progressing, to understand whether hospice may be appropriate, what to ask, and who will provide care.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Primary doctor / provider / phone _____

Main diagnosis or illness _____

Current location (home, AL, memory care, SNF, hospital) _____

Why are we considering hospice? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Serious illness is progressing | ☐ Wounds not healing; difficulty swallowing |
| ☐ More hospitalizations or ER visits | ☐ Treatment is no longer helping or is too hard on the person |
| ☐ More weakness / time in bed / sleeping | ☐ Doctors or palliative team have mentioned comfort care |
| ☐ Less eating or drinking; weight loss | ☐ The person wants comfort-focused care |
| ☐ More falls or infections | |
| ☐ More confusion or shortness of breath | |

Decline snapshot (use specific examples — patterns matter)

AREA	WHAT HAS CHANGED?	WHEN DID IT START?
Eating & drinking		
Weight		
Walking & daily activities		
Sleeping & breathing		
Pain & confusion		
Falls & infections		
Hospital / ER visits		

What matters most now? (in the person's own words, if they can answer)

What matters most to you right now? _____

What are you hoping for? _____

What are you afraid of? _____

Where do you feel safest? _____

What do you want to avoid if possible? _____

Who do you want involved in decisions? _____

Who will provide hands-on care?

Hospice supports the family but does not usually provide a full-time bedside caregiver. Plan who covers each need.

CARE NEED	WHO WILL HELP?	PHONE
Daytime caregiver		
Overnight caregiver		
Medication support		
Bathing & toileting		
After-hours call person		
Backup caregiver		

Documents to have ready

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Insurance cards | ☐ DNR / MOST / POLST (if applicable) |
| ☐ Medication list & doctor list | ☐ Recent hospital or rehab papers |
| ☐ Healthcare Power of Attorney | ☐ Emergency contacts |
| ☐ Living Will / Advance Directive | ☐ Funeral home information (if known) |

CHAPTER 13 · MEDICARE BASICS

■ **WORKSHEET — MEDICARE COVERAGE QUESTIONS**

Use this to understand what Medicare may cover, what it probably will not, and what to ask before a care decision.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Coverage type (Original Medicare / Advantage / unsure) _____

Plan name & phone _____

Part D drug plan / Medigap (if any) _____

Current care need (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Hospital | ☐ Doctor visit or medication |
| ☐ Rehab / skilled nursing facility | ☐ Assisted living or memory care |
| ☐ Home health | ☐ Private duty care |
| ☐ Hospice | ☐ Long-term nursing home care |
| ☐ Durable medical equipment | |

Skilled or custodial?

Is this care skilled, custodial, or both? Skilled ☐ Custodial ☐ Both ☐ Unsure ☐ — record who answered and when.

Coverage questions (record answers)

QUESTION	ANSWER	DATE
What part of Medicare applies?		
Is prior authorization required?		
Is the provider in network?		
What requirements must be met?		
What will Medicare / the plan pay?		
What will we owe (deductible/copay)?		
How long might coverage last?		
What could end coverage; can we appeal?		

Hospital status question (ask early, more than once)

Is my parent admitted as an inpatient, or under observation? Inpatient ☐ Observation / outpatient ☐ Unsure ☐ — record who answered and when.

Care Medicare usually does not pay for long-term (plan these separately)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Assisted living or memory care room and board | ☐ Daily supervision, meals, or housekeeping |
| ☐ Long-term custodial nursing home care | ☐ Companionship |
| ☐ Long blocks of private duty care | ☐ Ongoing bathing help as the only need |

How might this be paid instead?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Private pay | ☐ Family contribution |
| ☐ Long-term care insurance | ☐ State/local program |
| ☐ Medicaid (if eligible) | ☐ Unsure |
| ☐ VA benefits (if eligible) | |

Worksheet 10 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 13 · Medicare Basics* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 14 · MEDICAID BASICS

■ **WORKSHEET — MEDICAID PLANNING**

This does not replace legal, financial, or Medicaid advice. It helps the family gather information and ask better questions.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

State of residence / county _____

Current location (home, hospital, SNF, AL, memory care) _____

What are we trying to figure out? (check all that apply)

- ☐ Will Medicaid help pay for nursing facility care?
- ☐ Will Medicaid help pay for care at home?
- ☐ Is there a Medicaid waiver?
- ☐ Will Medicaid help in assisted living or memory care?
- ☐ What happens when private funds run out?
- ☐ How does the spouse at home stay protected?
- ☐ Does estate recovery apply?
- ☐ How do we apply?

Financial snapshot (for gathering information, not deciding alone)

INCOME / ASSET	SOURCE / INSTITUTION	APPROX. VALUE
Social Security / pension		
Checking / savings		
Investment / retirement accounts		
Life insurance		
Home / real estate		
Vehicle		
Burial / funeral policy		

Documents to gather (check when found)

- ☐ Social Security & Medicare cards
- ☐ Health insurance cards
- ☐ Birth & marriage certificates
- ☐ Social Security award letter
- ☐ Pension & bank statements
- ☐ Investment & retirement statements
- ☐ Life insurance policies
- ☐ Property deed & mortgage

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Vehicle title | ☐ Healthcare & Financial Power of Attorney |
| ☐ Funeral / burial policy | ☐ Level-of-care assessment |
| ☐ Trust documents | ☐ Records of any gifts or transfers |

Transfers & gifts (do not move money or property without advice)

Have any gifts or transfers been made recently? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐ — if yes or unsure, list date, what was transferred, to whom, and value, and ask a professional whether it creates a penalty.

CHAPTER 15 · PRIVATE PAY

■ **WORKSHEET — PRIVATE PAY PLANNING**

For planning only. It does not replace financial, legal, tax, Medicaid, or benefits advice.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Financial point person / phone _____

Financial Power of Attorney (if known) _____

Current care setting _____

Monthly income

SOURCE	MONTHLY AMOUNT	NOTES
Social Security		
Pension		
Retirement distribution		
Rental / investment income		
Other income		
Total monthly income		

Monthly care costs

COST	MONTHLY AMOUNT	NOTES
Private duty care		
Assisted living / memory care base rate		
Care level & medication fees		
Supplies & incontinence		
Transportation & adult day care		
Housing, utilities, maintenance		
Insurance premiums & copays		
Equipment & care manager		

Total monthly care costs		
--------------------------	--	--

Monthly gap & how long the plan lasts

Total monthly care costs _____

Total monthly income _____

Monthly gap (costs minus income) _____

Funds available for care _____

Estimated months this plan can last _____

Date to review the plan again _____

Available funds for care

ASSET / ACCOUNT	APPROX. VALUE	ACCESSIBLE?
Checking / savings		
Investment account		
Retirement account		
Home equity		
Life insurance cash value		

Other payment sources to explore (check all that may apply)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Long-term care insurance | ☐ Home sale |
| ☐ VA benefits | ☐ Reverse mortgage (with professional guidance) |
| ☐ Medicaid planning / waiver / HCBS | ☐ Life insurance options |
| ☐ Family contributions | ☐ State, local, or community support |

Family contribution plan (write it down clearly)

NAME	AMOUNT	FREQUENCY	GIFT OR LOAN?

Who pays the care bill? _____

Who tracks contributions? _____

What happens if someone cannot continue? _____

CHAPTER 16 · LONG-TERM CARE INSURANCE

■ **WORKSHEET — LONG-TERM CARE INSURANCE POLICY FINDER**

Use this to find out whether a policy exists and what to do next.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Person checking for policy / phone _____

Step 1: Is there a policy?

Policy found? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐ — if no, stop here and move to the next payment option. If yes or unsure, continue.

Step 2: Where did we look? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Important documents folder | ☐ Financial advisor files |
| ☐ Filing cabinet / safe / desk drawers | ☐ Tax files |
| ☐ Bank statements | ☐ Mail pile |
| ☐ Email | ☐ Employer or retirement benefit documents |
| ☐ Insurance folder / binder | ☐ Life insurance documents |

Step 3: Policy information

Insurance company _____

Policy number _____

Company phone _____

Agent / advisor / phone _____

Policy type: Traditional long-term care ☐ Life insurance with LTC rider ☐ Hybrid ☐ Unsure ☐

Step 4: What does it cover?

QUESTION	YES / NO / UNSURE	NOTES
Home care covered?		
Assisted living covered?		
Memory care covered?		
Nursing facility covered?		
Adult day care covered?		
Family caregiver covered?		

Licensed agency required?		
---------------------------	--	--

Step 5: Benefit details

Daily / monthly benefit amount _____

Total benefit pool _____

Elimination period & how it is counted _____

Inflation protection? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Reimbursement or cash benefit? _____

Worksheet 13 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 16 · Long-Term Care Insurance* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 17 · PRESCRIPTION ASSISTANCE

■ WORKSHEET — PRESCRIPTION ASSISTANCE

Use this when medication costs are high. It does not replace medical advice — do not stop, skip, or change medications without guidance from the prescriber or pharmacist.

Person receiving care _____

Medication point person / phone _____

Primary pharmacy / phone _____

Primary doctor / prescriber / phone _____

Current drug coverage

Coverage type: Medicare Part D ☐ Medicare Advantage w/ drug coverage ☐ Employer/retiree ☐ Medicaid ☐ VA ☐ None ☐ Unsure ☐

Plan name & phone _____

Preferred pharmacy (if known) _____

Mail-order option? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Medication cost list

MEDICATION	DOSE	PRESCRIBER	PHARMACY \$	INSURANCE \$

Three most expensive medications _____

CHAPTER 18 · VA BENEFITS

■ **WORKSHEET — VA BENEFITS SCREENING**

Use this when the person may be a Veteran, surviving spouse, or dependent. It does not determine eligibility — it helps the family gather information and ask the right questions.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

VA benefits point person / phone _____

Service information

Did the person serve in the U.S. military? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

Branch & dates of service _____

Wartime service? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Discharge status _____

DD214 found? (yes / searching) — location _____

Current VA connection (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Enrolled in VA health care | ☐ Receives Aid and Attendance or Housebound |
| ☐ Has VA primary care / uses VA pharmacy | ☐ Surviving spouse receives a VA benefit |
| ☐ Has a VA disability rating | ☐ Has a VA social worker |
| ☐ Receives VA compensation or pension | ☐ Unsure |

Surviving spouse (complete if applicable)

Veteran name & date of death _____

Marriage certificate found? (yes / searching) _____

Death certificate found? (yes / searching) _____

Survivor benefits already received? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Possible VA benefits to explore (check what to explore)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ VA health care enrollment | ☐ Long-term / home & community-based services |
| ☐ VA Pension / Survivors Pension | ☐ State Veterans home |
| ☐ Aid and Attendance | ☐ Caregiver support program |
| ☐ Housebound benefits | ☐ Respite |
| ☐ Service-connected disability compensation | ☐ Burial benefits |

Documents to gather (check when found)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ DD214 / separation papers | ☐ VA health care & Medicare cards |
| ☐ Social Security number & VA claim number | ☐ Marriage / death certificate (if survivor) |

- ☐ Medical records & doctor statement
- ☐ VA Form 21-2680 (if A&A/Housebound)
- ☐ Income, asset & bank statements
- ☐ Care invoices & medical expense receipts
- ☐ Power of attorney documents

Worksheet 15 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 18 · VA Benefits* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 19 · THE IMPORTANT DOCUMENTS FOLDER

■ **WORKSHEET — IMPORTANT DOCUMENTS FOLDER CHECKLIST**

The goal is simple: the right person can find the right document quickly.

Person receiving care _____

Date started / last updated _____

Document point person / phone _____

Backup document person / phone _____

Folder location & who has access

Paper folder location _____

Digital folder location _____

Password manager / access instructions _____

Who knows where the folder is _____

Emergency & medical contacts

ROLE	NAME	PHONE
Emergency contact		
Primary doctor		
Specialist		
Pharmacy		
Home health / hospice		
Preferred hospital		

Insurance & benefit cards (check when copied into the folder)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Medicare / Advantage / supplement | ☐ VA card |
| ☐ Part D prescription plan | ☐ Private / dental / vision insurance |
| ☐ Medicaid | ☐ Long-term care insurance information |

Healthcare decision documents

DOCUMENT	EXISTS?	COPY IN FOLDER?
Healthcare Power of Attorney		
Living Will / Advance Directive		

DNR / MOST / POLST		
HIPAA release		

Healthcare decision maker / phone _____

Alternate decision maker / phone _____

Financial & legal documents

DOCUMENT	EXISTS?	COPY IN FOLDER?
Financial Power of Attorney		
Will		
Trust		
Property deed / vehicle title		
Bank contact list / safe deposit info		

Attorney / phone _____

Financial advisor / phone _____

Accountant / phone _____

Care, benefits & military documents (check what applies)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Hospital / rehab discharge papers | ☐ Long-term care & life insurance policies |
| ☐ Home health or hospice paperwork | ☐ Pension / Social Security / Medicaid info |
| ☐ Facility or private duty agreement | ☐ DD214 / VA claim number / VA paperwork |
| ☐ Care plan / fall log | |

End-of-life & funeral information (a kindness to the family)

Funeral home preference / prepaid plan _____

Burial or cremation wishes _____

Cemetery information _____

Clergy / church contact _____

Important people to notify _____

Passwords & accounts

Do not write passwords in an unsafe place — use a secure password manager or trusted access plan.

Password manager used? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Who has access instructions? _____

Missing documents

MISSING DOCUMENT	WHO WILL FIND IT?	DUE DATE

Review schedule

Review this folder: Every 3 months ☐ After a hospitalization ☐ After medication or doctor changes ☐ After insurance changes ☐ After a move ☐ After legal documents are updated ☐

Next review date _____

Worksheet 16 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 19 · The Important Documents Folder* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 20 · HEALTHCARE POWER OF ATTORNEY

■ **WORKSHEET — HEALTHCARE POWER OF ATTORNEY**

This does not replace legal advice. State rules vary — ask an attorney if the document is missing, outdated, unclear, or if capacity is a concern.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Document point person / phone _____

Document status

Does a Healthcare Power of Attorney exist? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

Date signed & state _____

Attorney/office that prepared it / phone _____

Original document location _____

Copy in documents folder? (yes / needs to be added) _____

Named agents

ROLE	NAME	RELATIONSHIP & PHONE	HAS COPY?
Primary agent			
Backup agent			
Second backup (if any)			

Do the named people know they are named? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

Copies shared with (check all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Healthcare agent & backup | ☐ Home health / hospice |
| ☐ Primary doctor / specialist | ☐ Palliative care team |
| ☐ Hospital system | ☐ Attorney |
| ☐ Assisted living / memory care | ☐ Important documents folder |
| ☐ Skilled nursing facility | |

Capacity concern

Concern about the person's ability to understand or sign documents? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐ — if yes or unsure, ask the doctor and attorney what happens next.

CHAPTER 21 · LIVING WILL / ADVANCE DIRECTIVE

■ **WORKSHEET — LIVING WILL / ADVANCE DIRECTIVE**

This does not replace legal or medical advice. State rules vary — ask an attorney, doctor, or legal resource if the document is missing, outdated, unclear, or if capacity is a concern.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Healthcare agent / phone _____

Document status

Does a Living Will / Advance Directive exist? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

Date signed & state _____

Attorney/office that prepared it / phone _____

Original document location _____

Copy in documents folder? (yes / needs to be added) _____

What does the document address? (check all that apply)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ CPR | ☐ Hospital transfer / intensive care |
| ☐ Ventilator / breathing machine | ☐ Comfort care |
| ☐ Feeding tube | ☐ Hospice / palliative care |
| ☐ Artificial hydration | ☐ Organ donation |
| ☐ Dialysis | ☐ Spiritual wishes |
| ☐ Surgery / antibiotics | ☐ Preferred place of care |

The Wishes Conversation (ask while the person can still answer)

What matters most if you become seriously ill, and what would make life still feel meaningful?

What treatments would you want doctors to try — and what would you not want?

Would you want ICU care or a ventilator if recovery seemed unlikely? _____

Would you want artificial nutrition or hydration? _____

Would you want hospice or comfort-focused care if the illness progressed?

Where would you prefer to receive care, and who should be involved? _____

What do you want your family to remember if decisions get hard? _____

CHAPTER 22 · FINANCIAL POWER OF ATTORNEY

■ **WORKSHEET — FINANCIAL POWER OF ATTORNEY**

This does not replace legal, tax, Medicaid, or financial advice. State rules vary — ask a qualified professional if the document is missing, outdated, unclear, or if capacity is a concern.

Person receiving care _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Document point person / phone _____

Document status

Does a Financial Power of Attorney exist? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

Date signed & state _____

Attorney/office that prepared it / phone _____

Original document location _____

Is it durable? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐

When does authority begin? Immediately ☐ After incapacity ☐ Unsure ☐

Named agents

ROLE	NAME	RELATIONSHIP & PHONE	HAS COPY?
Primary agent			
Backup agent			

Institutions to contact (will they accept the document?)

INSTITUTION	CONTACT / PHONE	POA ACCEPTED? (Y/N/PENDING)
Bank		
Investment / retirement firm		
Insurance / long-term care insurance		
Mortgage / landlord / utilities		
Facility business office		

Financial responsibilities needing attention (check all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Bills need to be paid | ☐ Care bills or facility contract |
| ☐ Mail needs to be reviewed | ☐ Long-term care insurance claim to file |
| ☐ Bank accounts need monitoring | ☐ Medicaid or VA application may be needed |

☐ Taxes need filing

☐ Subscriptions to cancel

☐ Home maintenance or possible sale

☐ Fraud or scam risk

Monthly bills & care costs

BILL / EXPENSE	AMOUNT	DUE	PAID FROM
Mortgage / rent / utilities			
Insurance			
Assisted living / memory care			
Private duty care			
Medical bills & medications			

Record-keeping plan

Who will keep records? _____

Where will records be kept? _____

Who receives updates, and how often? _____

CHAPTER 23 · MEDICAL ORDERS — DNR, MOST, AND POLST

■ **WORKSHEET — THINKING ABOUT YOUR PREFERENCES**

This worksheet is not a DNR, MOST, or POLST, and it has no legal or medical effect. Only an order signed by a healthcare provider on your state's official form directs medical care. Use this page to think and talk — then bring it to that conversation. It is written in your parent's voice; hand it to them if they can complete it, or work through it together.

1. If my heart stops, I would want:

- ☐ CPR ☐ No CPR (DNR)

2. If I become seriously ill, I would prefer:

- ☐ Full treatment (all possible medical care)
☐ Limited treatment (some interventions, but not all)
☐ Comfort care only

3. I would want to be cared for:

- ☐ At home ☐ With hospice support, wherever I am
☐ In a hospital

4. I have discussed my wishes with:

- ☐ Family members ☐ Legal decision-maker
☐ Healthcare provider

5. Additional notes about my preferences:**For the family (check when done)**

- ☐ Asked the provider whether a MOST/POLST/DNR is appropriate now
☐ Order signed on the state's official form
☐ Original visible with the person (refrigerator / front of chart / binder front)
☐ Copies in the documents folder and with the decision maker
☐ Family, caregivers, and facility know it exists and where it is
☐ Review date set (and at every care transition)

CHAPTER 24 · ADVANCE CARE PLANNING CONVERSATIONS

■ WORKSHEET — ADVANCE CARE PLANNING CONVERSATION

Use this to guide conversations about future care, values, wishes, decision makers, and documents. It does not replace legal or medical advice — it helps the family talk before a crisis.

Person receiving care _____

Date of conversation _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Healthcare decision maker / agent / phone _____

Backup decision maker / phone _____

What matters most? (check any priorities mentioned)

- ☐ Staying at home
- ☐ Being comfortable / avoiding pain
- ☐ Living as long as possible
- ☐ Being able to communicate
- ☐ Recognizing family
- ☐ Avoiding burden on family
- ☐ Avoiding repeated hospital trips
- ☐ Being with family
- ☐ Faith / prayer / spiritual support
- ☐ Maintaining independence
- ☐ Avoiding machines

In the person's own words _____

What are you hoping for? _____

What are you worried about? _____

What would make life still feel meaningful — and what would feel like too much?

Care preferences

CARE QUESTION	WISHES / NOTES
Hospital transfer / ICU	
CPR	
Ventilator / breathing machine	
Feeding tube / artificial hydration	
Dialysis / surgery / antibiotics	
Palliative care / hospice	
Comfort-focused care	

Preferred place of care (if illness worsens)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Home | ☐ Skilled nursing facility |
| ☐ Assisted living | ☐ Hospice facility |
| ☐ Memory care | ☐ Unsure |
| ☐ Hospital | |

Faith, spiritual & personal wishes

Faith or spiritual support desired? (yes / no / unsure) _____

Clergy / spiritual contact & phone _____

Music, prayer, rituals, readings, or personal comforts _____

Important people to include _____

Decision maker & documents

Primary decision maker / phone _____

Backup decision maker / phone _____

Does the named person know? Yes ☐ No ☐ Needs conversation ☐

Matches the Healthcare POA? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐ No document found ☐

Documents that exist (check)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Healthcare Power of Attorney | ☐ Financial Power of Attorney |
| ☐ Living Will / Advance Directive | ☐ HIPAA release |
| ☐ DNR / MOST / POLST | ☐ Important documents folder |

CHAPTER 25 · MEDICATION AND DOCTOR LISTS

■ **WORKSHEET — MEDICATION AND DOCTOR LIST**

Create one clear list for appointments, emergencies, hospital visits, home health, hospice, assisted living, memory care, or rehab.

Person receiving care _____

Date last updated _____

Medication-list person / phone _____

Primary pharmacy / phone _____

Allergies & medication reactions _____

Current medication list

MEDICATION	DOSE	HOW OFTEN / TIME	REASON	PRESCRIBER

As-needed medications

MEDICATION	DOSE	WHEN USED	MAX ALLOWED

Over-the-counter, vitamins & supplements

ITEM	DOSE	HOW OFTEN	REASON

Recently stopped medications

MEDICATION	DATE STOPPED	WHO STOPPED IT?	REASON

Medication concerns (check any that apply)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Missed or extra doses | ☐ Dizziness, falls, or sleepiness |
| ☐ Confusing instructions | ☐ New confusion or poor appetite |
| ☐ Duplicate medications | ☐ Nausea or constipation |
| ☐ Old bottles still in use | ☐ Trouble swallowing pills |
| ☐ Multiple pharmacies or prescribers | ☐ Refusing medications |
| ☐ High cost | |

Doctor & care team list

NAME	ROLE / SPECIALTY	PHONE	NEXT VISIT
Primary doctor			
Specialist			
Specialist			
Pharmacy			
Home health / hospice			
Facility nurse			

Medication safety plan

Who fills the pill box, and how often? _____

Who checks for missed doses? _____

Where are medications stored? _____

Are old medications removed from the home? (yes / no / needs attention) _____

Who updates the list after changes? _____

CHAPTER 26 · EMERGENCY CONTACTS AND CRISIS PLAN

■ **WORKSHEET — EMERGENCY CONTACTS & CRISIS PLAN**

Create one clear emergency page. The goal: the right person can find the right number fast.

Person receiving care / date of birth _____

Address _____

Main diagnosis / conditions _____

Allergies _____

Medication list location _____

Preferred hospital _____

Important documents folder location _____

Family point people

ROLE	NAME	PHONE
Main family point person		
Backup point person		
Healthcare agent		
Main caregiver		
Backup caregiver		

Medical contacts

CONTACT	NAME / ORGANIZATION	PHONE	AFTER-HOURS
Primary doctor			
Specialist			
Pharmacy			
Home health			
Hospice			
Facility nurse			

Call 911 for (check to confirm the caregiver knows)

☐ Chest pain

☐ Severe trouble breathing

- ☐ Stroke signs — sudden face drooping, arm weakness, or speech trouble (note the time)
- ☐ Unconsciousness
- ☐ Uncontrolled bleeding

- ☐ Serious fall or major injury
- ☐ Severe allergic reaction
- ☐ Fire or unsafe environment
- ☐ Immediate danger to self or others

Hospice / home health

On hospice? Yes ☐ No ☐ Receiving home health? Yes ☐ No ☐

Hospice agency / main & after-hours number _____

Hospice nurse _____

Home health agency / number _____

Instructions from the team _____

Documents & medical orders (check what applies)

- ☐ Healthcare POA
- ☐ Living Will / Advance Directive
- ☐ DNR / MOST / POLST
- ☐ Medication & allergy list
- ☐ Insurance / Medicare / Medicaid / VA cards
- ☐ Long-term care insurance

Family call chain

ORDER	WHO GETS CALLED?	PHONE	WHO CALLS THEM?
1			
2			
3			

Before you call — what changed?

Awake & responsive? Yes ☐ No ☐ Unsure ☐ Fall? Y ☐ N ☐ Breathing trouble? Y ☐ N ☐
 Chest pain? Y ☐ N ☐ New confusion? Y ☐ N ☐ Fever? Y ☐ N ☐ New pain? Y ☐ N ☐
 Medication change? Y ☐ N ☐

CHAPTER 27 · THE LAST DAYS PLAN

■ **WORKSHEET — LAST DAYS PLAN**

Use this when a serious illness is progressing or hospice is involved. It does not replace medical advice — call the care team with any concern, and 911 for immediate danger if emergency treatment is wanted or needed.

Person receiving care / current location _____

Main caregiver / phone _____

Family point person / phone _____

Healthcare decision maker / phone _____

Current care team

ROLE	NAME / AGENCY	PHONE	AFTER-HRS
Primary doctor			
Hospice agency / nurse			
Facility nurse			
Pharmacy			
Funeral home			
Clergy / spiritual			

Who do we call first? (check the plan)

If the person is on hospice with comfort-focused goals, hospice is usually the first call — day or night.

- ☐ 911 for immediate danger or emergency treatment
 ☐ Primary doctor
- ☐ Hospice
 ☐ Palliative care team
- ☐ Facility nurse

First call number _____

Backup call number _____

Documents confirmed (check what exists, note location)

- ☐ Healthcare POA
 ☐ Medication list
- ☐ Living Will / Advance Directive
 ☐ Insurance cards
- ☐ DNR / MOST / POLST
 ☐ Funeral home information

Comfort priorities (check what matters most now)

- ☐ Pain relief
 ☐ Anxiety / restlessness relief
- ☐ Breathing comfort
 ☐ Quiet room

- ☐ Family nearby
- ☐ Prayer / spiritual support
- ☐ Music

- ☐ Familiar blanket or photos
- ☐ Avoiding hospital transfer if possible
- ☐ Staying in current location if possible

Symptoms to watch (ask the care team what to do)

SYMPTOM	WHAT WE WERE TOLD TO DO	WHO TO CALL
Pain		
Shortness of breath		
Anxiety / restlessness		
Breathing changes		
Trouble swallowing		
Not eating / drinking		

Comfort medications (use only as directed by the care team)

MEDICATION	WHAT IT IS FOR	DOSE / INSTRUCTIONS	WHEN TO CALL

Who taught the family how to use these, and when? _____

People to notify if time becomes short

NAME	RELATIONSHIP	PHONE	WHEN?

What to say — words the family may want to share

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| I love you. | We are here. |
| Thank you. | You are not alone. |
| I forgive you. | We will take care of each other. |
| Please forgive me. | You can rest. |

If death occurs (ask the care team ahead of time)

Who do we call first? / phone _____

Who pronounces death? _____

Funeral home & who calls them _____

Who updates family? _____

What happens with medications & equipment? _____

Special faith, cultural, or family wishes _____

Family role assignments

ROLE	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	PHONE
Main bedside contact		
Family updates		
Calls hospice / nurse		
Handles documents		
Calls funeral home		
Supports spouse / caregiver		

Worksheet 24 of 25 · goes with *Chapter 27 · The Last Days Plan* in the book · Copy freely for your family's use.

CHAPTER 29 · AFTER DEATH

■ **WORKSHEET — AFTER-DEATH PLAN**

Fill in as much as you can ahead of time. This does not replace guidance from hospice, the facility, or the funeral home. In an unexpected death with no plan, call 911.

Person receiving care _____

Current location _____

Family point person / phone _____

Who to call first

First call: Hospice ☐ Facility staff ☐ Doctor (expected home death) ☐ 911 (unexpected / no plan) ☐

CONTACT	NAME / AGENCY	PHONE (INCL. AFTER-HOURS)
Hospice		
Doctor who will sign		
Facility staff		
Funeral home		
Clergy / spiritual support		

Documents ready (check what is visible / located)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ DNR / POLST visible for responders | ☐ Funeral or burial wishes / prepaid plan |
| ☐ Healthcare POA & advance directive | ☐ Important documents folder |
| ☐ Insurance & Social Security information | |

Time in the room — what would bring comfort? (check any)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Sitting together | ☐ Gathering family to say goodbye |
| ☐ Holding a hand | ☐ Bathing or dressing the person |
| ☐ Prayer / scripture | ☐ A quiet, private room |
| ☐ Music | |

Faith, cultural & personal wishes at the time of death

Clergy or spiritual contact to call _____

Rituals, prayers, or readings to honor _____

Who should be present _____

Anything to avoid _____

People to notify (after the first hours)

NAME	RELATIONSHIP	PHONE	WHO CALLS?

■ **First Days — Practical Checklist (none of this is urgent)**

- ☐ Order several copies of the death certificate
- ☐ Meet with the funeral home to make arrangements
- ☐ Notify Social Security
- ☐ Contact pension, VA, and life insurance
- ☐ Notify banks; change or close accounts
- ☐ Cancel appointments, subscriptions, and services
- ☐ Notify employer or organizations, if applicable
- ☐ Return or arrange pickup of medical equipment
- ☐ Dispose of medications safely (hospice can help)
- ☐ Begin sorting belongings when ready

Point person leading these tasks / phone _____

Next step, and when _____